FIRST WORLD WAR AND AFTERMATH

WHY QUICK WAR FAILED → ATTRITION BATTLEFIELD → SEA-WAR MECHANISM → 1917 STRATEGIC EXCHANGE → HOW THE CENTRAL POWERS → TOTAL-WAR SOCIETY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ★ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 WHY QUICK WAR FAILED

WHY QUICK WAR FAILED · MARNE, SEPT 1914 · GERMAN ADVANCE HALTED · DEFENSIVE FIREPOWER · MOVEMENT CANNOT EXPLOIT SUCCESS · WESTERN FRONT HARDENS · STRATEGY SHIFTS FROM MANOEUVRE TO ENDURANCE · MUST REMEMBER

MARNE, SEPT 1914 → German advance halted → DEFENSIVE FIREPOWER → movement cannot exploit success → TRENCHES → western front hardens → RESULT → strategy shifts from manoeuvre to endurance → MUST REMEMBER: Mobilisation and stalemate in 1914, total-war economies, multiple European and imperial fronts, US

CORE CLAIM
- MARNE, SEPT 1914 → German advance halted
- DEFENSIVE FIREPOWER → movement cannot exploit success

MECHANISM
- TRENCHES → western front hardens
- RESULT → strategy shifts from manoeuvre to endurance

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Mobilisation and stalemate in 1914, total-war economies, multiple European and imperial fronts, US
- entry and Russian exit in 1917, and the November 1918 armistice must remain chronologically distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → strategy shifts from manoeuvre to endurance.

01

STAGE 01 ATTRITION BATTLEFIELD

ATTRITION BATTLEFIELD · VERDUN 1916 · PROLONGED EXHAUSTION · SOMME 1916 · HUGE COST AND LIMITED GROUND · MACHINE-GUNS AND ARTILLERY DOMINATE · STRATEGIC TEST · MANPOWER, INDUSTRY AND MORALE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
VERDUN 1916 → prolonged exhaustion	DEFENCE → machine-guns and artillery dominate	VERDUN 1916 → prolonged exhaustion
SOMME 1916 → huge cost and limited ground	STRATEGIC TEST → manpower, industry and morale	SOMME 1916 → huge cost and limited ground

CORE CLAIM
- VERDUN 1916 → prolonged exhaustion
- SOMME 1916 → huge cost and limited ground

MECHANISM
- DEFENCE → machine-guns and artillery dominate
- STRATEGIC TEST → manpower, industry and morale

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- VERDUN 1916 → prolonged exhaustion
- SOMME 1916 → huge cost and limited ground

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOMME 1916 → huge cost and limited ground.

02

STAGE 02 SEA-WAR MECHANISM

SEA-WAR MECHANISM · BRITISH FLEET · BLOCKADE CENTRAL POWERS · NO DECISIVE TACTICAL RESOLUTION · GERMAN U-BOATS · UNRESTRICTED CAMPAIGN · SHIPPING LOSSES REDUCED; BRITISH CONTROL SURVIVES

BRITISH FLEET → blockade Central Powers → JUTLAND → no decisive tactical resolution → GERMAN U-BOATS → unrestricted campaign → CONVOYS → shipping losses reduced; British control survives

CORE CLAIM
- BRITISH FLEET → blockade Central Powers
- JUTLAND → no decisive tactical resolution

MECHANISM
- GERMAN U-BOATS → unrestricted campaign
- CONVOYS → shipping losses reduced; British control survives

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BRITISH FLEET → blockade Central Powers
- JUTLAND → no decisive tactical resolution

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONVOYS → shipping losses reduced; British control survives.

03

STAGE 03 1917 STRATEGIC EXCHANGE

1917 STRATEGIC EXCHANGE · REVOLUTION AND EXIT REDUCE GERMANY'S EASTERN BURDEN · ENTRY ADDS FINANCE, FOOD, SHIPPING, MORALE AND TROOPS · GERMAN GAMBLE · SUBMARINE WARFARE HELPS TRIGGER US ENTRY · NET EFFECT · AMERICAN RESOURCES OFFSET RUSSIAN WITHDRAWAL

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RUSSIA → revolution and exit reduce Germany's eastern burden	GERMAN GAMBLE → submarine warfare helps trigger US entry	RUSSIA → revolution and exit reduce Germany's eastern burden
USA → entry adds finance, food, shipping, morale and troops	NET EFFECT → American resources offset Russian withdrawal	USA → entry adds finance, food, shipping, morale and troops

CORE CLAIM
- RUSSIA → revolution and exit reduce Germany's eastern burden
- USA → entry adds finance, food, shipping, morale and troops

MECHANISM
- GERMAN GAMBLE → submarine warfare helps trigger US entry
- NET EFFECT → American resources offset Russian withdrawal

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RUSSIA → revolution and exit reduce Germany's eastern burden
- USA → entry adds finance, food, shipping, morale and troops

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NET EFFECT → American resources offset Russian withdrawal.

04

STAGE 04 HOW THE CENTRAL POWERS LOST

HOW THE CENTRAL POWERS LOST · TWO FRONTS · GERMANY'S STRUCTURAL BURDEN · SUPPLIES AND CIVILIAN ENDURANCE WEAKEN · 1918 OFFENSIVE · LUDENDORFF FAILS · ALLIES COLLAPSE · BULGARIA, HABSBURG AND OTTOMAN SYSTEMS FALL

TWO FRONTS → Germany's structural burden → BLOCKADE → supplies and civilian endurance weaken → 1918 OFFENSIVE → Ludendorff fails → ALLIES COLLAPSE → Bulgaria, Habsburg and Ottoman systems fall

CORE CLAIM
- TWO FRONTS → Germany's structural burden
- BLOCKADE → supplies and civilian endurance weaken

MECHANISM
- 1918 OFFENSIVE → Ludendorff fails
- ALLIES COLLAPSE → Bulgaria, Habsburg and Ottoman systems fall

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- TWO FRONTS → Germany's structural burden
- BLOCKADE → supplies and civilian endurance weaken

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ALLIES COLLAPSE → Bulgaria, Habsburg and Ottoman systems fall.

05

STAGE 05 TOTAL-WAR SOCIETY

TOTAL-WAR SOCIETY · CONTROLS INDUSTRY, TRANSPORT AND FOOD · ENTER EXPANDED WARTIME PRODUCTION ROLES · BLOCKADE AND PROPAGANDA MAKE HOME FRONT STRATEGIC · COLONIAL MANPOWER AND TERRITORY GLOBALISE THE WAR

STATE → controls industry, transport and food

WOMEN → enter expanded wartime production roles → CIVILIANS → blockade and propaganda make home front strategic → EMPIRE → colonial manpower and territory globalise the war

CORE CLAIM
- STATE → controls industry, transport and food
- WOMEN → enter expanded wartime production roles

MECHANISM
- CIVILIANS → blockade and propaganda make home front strategic
- EMPIRE → colonial manpower and territory globalise the war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- STATE → controls industry, transport and food
- WOMEN → enter expanded wartime production roles

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EMPIRE → colonial manpower and territory globalise the war.

06

STAGE 06 POLITICAL EARTHQUAKE

POLITICAL EARTHQUAKE · BOLSHEVIK RULE · REVOLUTION AND WEIMAR REPUBLIC · EMPIRES COLLAPSE INTO NEW ARRANGEMENTS · GLOBAL POWER · USA AND JAPAN GAIN AS EUROPE WEAKENS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule	HABSBURG/OTTOMAN → empires collapse into new arrangements	RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule
GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic	GLOBAL POWER → USA and Japan gain as Europe weakens	GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic

CORE CLAIM
- RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule
- GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic

MECHANISM
- HABSBURG/OTTOMAN → empires collapse into new arrangements
- GLOBAL POWER → USA and Japan gain as Europe weakens

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RUSSIA → Bolshevik rule
- GERMANY → revolution and Weimar Republic

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GLOBAL POWER → USA and Japan gain as Europe weakens.

07

STAGE 07 FIVE-TREATY MATCHING

FIVE-TREATY MATCHING · GERMANY; ST GERMAIN · HUNGARY; NEUILLY · OTTOMAN TURKEY, REJECTED · LAUSANNE 1923 · REVISED TURKISH SETTLEMENT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
VERSAILLES → Germany; ST GERMAIN → Austria	SEVRES → Ottoman Turkey, rejected	VERSAILLES → Germany; ST GERMAIN → Austria
TRIANON → Hungary; NEUILLY → Bulgaria	LAUSANNE 1923 → revised Turkish settlement	TRIANON → Hungary; NEUILLY → Bulgaria

CORE CLAIM
- VERSAILLES → Germany; ST GERMAIN → Austria
- TRIANON → Hungary; NEUILLY → Bulgaria

MECHANISM
- SEVRES → Ottoman Turkey, rejected
- LAUSANNE 1923 → revised Turkish settlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- VERSAILLES → Germany; ST GERMAIN → Austria
- TRIANON → Hungary; NEUILLY → Bulgaria

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SEVRES → Ottoman Turkey, rejected; LAUSANNE 1923 → revised Turkish settlement.

08

STAGE 08 VERSAILLES CONTAINMENT

VERSAILLES CONTAINMENT · ALSACE-LORRAINE, POLAND, DANZIG, SAAR · 100,000 ARMY; NO CONSCRIPTION OR KEY WEAPONS · UNION WITH GERMANY FORBIDDEN

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
TERRITORY → Alsace-Lorraine, Poland, Danzig, Saar	RHINELAND → demilitarised	TERRITORY → Alsace-Lorraine, Poland, Danzig, Saar
MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons	AUSTRIA → union with Germany forbidden	MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons

CORE CLAIM
- TERRITORY → Alsace-Lorraine, Poland, Danzig, Saar
- MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons

MECHANISM
- RHINELAND → demilitarised
- AUSTRIA → union with Germany forbidden

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- TERRITORY → Alsace-Lorraine, Poland, Danzig, Saar
- MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MILITARY → 100,000 army; no conscription or key weapons.

09

STAGE 09 ARTICLE 231 AND REPARATIONS

ARTICLE 231 AND REPARATIONS · ARTICLE 231 · LEGAL LIABILITY FOR ALLIED LOSS AND DAMAGE · READ IN GERMANY AS WAR-GUILT CLAUSE · REPARATIONS FIXED AT £6600 MILLION · REVISIONIST GRIEVANCE PLUS ENFORCEMENT PROBLEM · CLOSE DISTINCTION · MILITARY VICTORY, ARMISTICE, PARIS PEACE TREATIES, VERSAILLES PROVISIONS AND

ARTICLE 231 → legal liability for Allied loss and damage → POLITICS → read in Germany as war-guilt clause → 1921 → reparations fixed at £6600 million → EFFECT → revisionist grievance plus enforcement problem → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Military victory, armistice, Paris peace treaties, Versailles provisions and the League settlement were

CORE CLAIM
- ARTICLE 231 → legal liability for Allied loss and damage
- POLITICS → read in Germany as war-guilt clause

MECHANISM
- 1921 → reparations fixed at £6600 million
- EFFECT → revisionist grievance plus enforcement problem

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Military victory, armistice, Paris peace treaties, Versailles provisions and the League settlement were separate stages
- treaty grievance neither explains the whole war nor makes a second war automatic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Military victory, armistice, Paris peace treaties, Versailles provisions and the League settlement were separate stages; treaty grievance neither explains the whole war nor makes a second war automatic.

10

STAGE 10 MANDATES: CHANGE AND CONTINUITY

CHANGE AND CONTINUITY · OLD LANGUAGE · CONQUEST AND ANNEXATION · NEW LANGUAGE · LEAGUE TRUSTEESHIP AND PREPARATION FOR INDEPENDENCE · BRITAIN AND FRANCE RETAIN IMPERIAL CONTROL · EMPIRE SURVIVES UNDER CONDITIONAL JUSTIFICATION · EVIDENCE LIMIT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
OLD LANGUAGE → conquest and annexation	VERDICT → empire survives under conditional justification	German punishment alone.
NEW LANGUAGE → League trusteeship and preparation for independence	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Mass death, revolution, empire collapse, mandates, minority problems and colonial	
PRACTICE → Britain and France retain imperial control	mobilisation remade the world beyond Europe, so aftermath cannot be reduced to	

CORE CLAIM
- OLD LANGUAGE → conquest and annexation
- NEW LANGUAGE → League trusteeship and preparation for independence
- PRACTICE → Britain and France retain imperial control

MECHANISM
- VERDICT → empire survives under conditional justification
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Mass death, revolution, empire collapse, mandates, minority problems and colonial
- mobilisation remade the world beyond Europe, so aftermath cannot be reduced to

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- German punishment alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Mass death, revolution, empire collapse, mandates, minority problems and colonial mobilisation remade the world beyond Europe, so aftermath cannot be reduced to.

11

STAGE 11 WAR-AND-PEACE ANSWER SPINE

WAR-AND-PEACE ANSWER SPINE · FAILED QUICK WAR, ATTRITION, BLOCKADE AND COALITION COLLAPSE · TOTAL WAR · STATE, SOCIETY, WOMEN, CIVILIANS AND EMPIRE · TREATY CLUSTER, LEAGUE, MANDATES AND MINORITIES · POLITICAL EARTHQUAKE FOLLOWED BY UNSTABLE PEACE

COURSE → failed quick war, attrition, blockade and coalition collapse → TOTAL WAR → state, society, women, civilians and empire → SETTLEMENT → treaty cluster, League, mandates and minorities → VERDICT → political earthquake followed by unstable peace

CORE CLAIM
- COURSE → failed quick war, attrition, blockade and coalition collapse
- TOTAL WAR → state, society, women, civilians and empire

MECHANISM
- SETTLEMENT → treaty cluster, League, mandates and minorities
- VERDICT → political earthquake followed by unstable peace

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COURSE → failed quick war, attrition, blockade and coalition collapse
- TOTAL WAR → state, society, women, civilians and empire

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → political earthquake followed by unstable peace.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · TANKS, SUBMARINES, BOMBERS, MACHINE-GUNS, HEAVY ARTILLERY AND GAS CHANGED · WOMEN ENTERED FACTORY AND OTHER WARTIME ROLES ON A · WHOLE SOCIETIES WERE MOBILIZED · BLOCKADE HARDSHIP HIT CIVILIANS, ESPECIALLY IN THE CENTRAL POWERS · DICTATED PEACE WITHOUT GERMAN PARTICIPATION · TERRITORIAL LOSSES, ESPECIALLY WHERE GERMANS REMAINED OUTSIDE THE REICH · ARTICLE 231, READ IN GERMANY AS A WAR-GUILT CLAUSE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- tanks, submarines, bombers, machine-guns, heavy artillery and gas changed warfare;
- women entered factory and other wartime roles on a much larger scale;
- whole societies were mobilized;
- blockade hardship hit civilians, especially in the Central Powers and Russia.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- dictated peace without German participation;
- territorial losses, especially where Germans remained outside the Reich;
- Article 231, read in Germany as a war-guilt clause and used by the Allies as a legal basis for reparations;
- reparations set at £6600 million.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- some territorial changes were defensible on nationality grounds;
- many terms broadly reflected Wilsonian ideas plus later wartime hardening;
- Germany had itself imposed Brest-Litovsk harshly on Russia.
- Europe was split between revisionist states and status-quo states;

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels